



Girlguiding Hertfordshire

Walking team

Newsletter – Autumn 2026

email walking@girlguidinghertfordshire.org.uk
facebook.com/hertsguideswalkingteam

Wow, what a fabulously full Summer! We started with incredibly hot hiking in Snowdonia, closely followed by Grace completing her level 2 walking qualification in the Bannau Brycheiniog National Park (Brecon Beacons). Well done Grace! In late August many of us walked in beautiful Wensleydale too.

A fantastic County Camp saw approximately 160 Guides enjoying orienteering and geocaching and they were joined by about 60 Rangers for an evening challenge hike. In addition 190 Brownies completed Explore 2. It was super busy but super fun in a wonderful woodland venue. Several units also had geocaching visits on their normal nights.

We have a full programme for this accademic year, including the launch of our new challenge: Together We Have Walked The Hertfordshire Way. Suitable for all sections, there will be weekend participation events and you can walk your local sections with your unit too. Look out for more information soon.

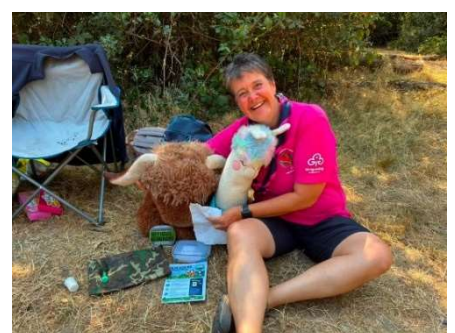
Finally, our Duke of Edinburgh's (DofE) Award team will be running a Bronze/Silver programme this year, with Gold at region level. Expedition dates will be provided shortly.

There is something for everyone, but book fast – 2 big Autumn events, National Walking Week and the level 2 walking weekend in the Peak District are already fully booked.

Happy walking!

Herts Guides walking team

walking@girlguidinghertfordshire.org.uk



Events diary

25 October – [Adult social walk in Panshanger Park](#), Hertford, 10am–12pm. Come and enjoy awesome Autumn colours, meet the team, have a natter, relax in nature. email walking@girlguidinghertfordshire.org.uk to book your place.

16 January – First adult social walk of the new year, to launch our exciting challenge: [Together We Have Walked The Hertfordshire Way](#). Full details will follow in November Billboard and on social media.

14 March – Local first steps [navigation training](#) for Guides, Rangers, young leaders and adults. Allow us to equip you with the skills you need to get out and about this year. More information to follow, but email walking@girlguidinghertfordshire.org.uk if interested.

19 – 21 March – [Mountain Experience](#) (MX27) for Rangers, young leaders and adults in the Peak District. (Leaders do not need to attend with girls). A fun weekend learning higher level map and compass skills but staying cosily indoors overnight. Fully catered, transport included, £95 per person. Good for personal skills, DofE training, Peak Assault training, lowland leader or Girlguiding walking scheme training. Places are very limited! Email: walking@girlguidinghertfordshire.org.uk to book on.

30 April – 3 May – [ITTH](#) Introduction to the hills for Guides aged 11–13. A jam-packed camping weekend of fun and adventure including climbing, cycling, caving and hill walking. Bookings are now open, but spaces will disappear fast! Click on the underlined blue link for a flyer.

22 May – [Incident hike](#) An 8km hike, taking 3.5–4 hours, for Guides and Rangers to compete in teams of 4–8; to build independence, teamwork, and outdoor confidence. Leaders are welcome to accompany inexperienced teams or come on one of our navigation training events. £5 per girl. A booking form will be available nearer the time. For now, enquiries via walking@girlguidinghertfordshire.org.uk

4–6 June tbc – [Social lowland walking weekend](#) for adults on the South Downs Way. More information to follow.

12 June – [Chalk Stream challenge](#) An opportunity at the River Ver, Verulamium Park, St Albans for Rainbows, Brownies and Guides to explore nature and learn about local heritage.

Advance notice: October 2027 date tbc – Peak Assault – an upland orienteering event run by Hertfordshire Scouts that pushes navigation, teamwork and outdoor skills to the next level. It's tough, it's exhilarating, and it's the kind of adventure they will talk about for years. It is open to Rangers, young leaders and adults. U18's can either walk with a qualified adult in a training team, or remain independent if they have prior experience of remote terrain; so if they've done Mountain Experience, Gold DofE or lots of personal walking. Its super fun, but tough as full kit must be carried including tents and stoves for overnight camping.